



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Millennium Charter Academy
School Website: <https://www.mcacademy.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Millennium Charter Academy NC 27030 (MCA) presents a robust, public-charter implementation of classical education on a K–12 campus. Across mission, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and family/community involvement, MCA foregrounds truth, goodness, and beauty, formation of virtuous character, and the liberal-arts core (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Books; humane letters; memory work; Socratic/dialogic pedagogy). Public-facing materials repeatedly emphasize formation of virtuous citizens, formation of character, and a life-long pursuit of knowledge in service of moral and civic purpose rather than mere workforce preparation. The school also foregrounds parent partnership and community involvement as a core feature of its classical model.

Overall, MCA aligns strongly with Classical education criteria. In every category below, MCA demonstrates substantial evidence for classic aims (virtue formation, true/beautiful/good, Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, Socratic and paideia-style pedagogy, a living-faculty emphasis, and active parent/community partnership). Quantitative keyword analysis shows widespread appearance of Positive Keywords (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, formational aims, Great Books, paideia, scholé, Socratic seminar, living curriculum, partnership with families) with minimal to no appearance of Negative Keywords in the core public materials. Therefore, the six-category assessment places MCA firmly in CLASSICAL, with only minor caveats where the public-facing content emphasizes liberal-arts content and civic formation over religious liturgy or doctrinal theology (which MCA does not frame as a religious institution, but as a classical-liberal-arts approach).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations** — CLASSICAL Evidence shows explicit emphasis on transcendent truths: truth, goodness, beauty; virtuous character; moral formation; and a teleology oriented toward wisdom and moral order. While liturgical/theological rituals are not foregrounded (MCA presents as a public charter with a broad civic and moral formation focus), the public materials clearly articulate transcendentals and virtue as foundational. Positive keywords far outweigh negatives in the available materials. Why classical: The school emphasizes truth, goodness, beauty as real ideals and centers character formation and virtue, not just technique or jobs.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal** — CLASSICAL Evidence shows formation of virtue and wisdom as telos, not merely workforce prep; the aim is formation of a virtuous citizenry with a seamless integration of liberal arts and moral development; emphasis on the true/good/beautiful. The public materials repeatedly frame education as formation and moral development, not primarily as job preparation.
- **Element 3: Curriculum** — CLASSICAL Evidence shows explicit Trivium and Quadrivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy), Great Books/Great Conversations, humane letters, and a deliberate interdisciplinary, integrated approach (English/history/philosophy in Humane

Letters; cross-disciplinary study). Great Books and classical canon are foregrounded, as is wonder in learning.

- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL Evidence shows contemplative/restful elements (Scholé) in lower grades; singing/chanting/memory work in lower grades; Socratic/seminar/paideia-style methods in upper grades; emphasis on disciplined argument, debate, and rhetoric. The presence of paideia seminars and disciplined, memory-focused pedagogy aligns strongly with classical pedagogy.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence shows a model-teacher approach where faculty are central to delivering the living curriculum, with teacher-led explorations (Exploratory Courses) and a focus on mentors and virtuous exemplars. The materials emphasize how faculty drive the learning and how their passions shape Exploratory Courses, indicating a faculty-centered, virtuous-model environment.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence shows deliberate partnership with families (parents as co-teachers; academic-civic formation; parent involvement opportunities; parent education/gatherings; campus openness). MCA discusses family involvement, parent governance-leaning structures, and community partnerships, which align with classical-community formation expectations.

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Since MCA is already CLASSICAL across all six categories, there is no need for major needle-moving changes. If desired, minor enhancements could further emphasize liturgical or theological grounding (without compromising the public-charter status), and explicitly foreground “great conversation” language in more public-facing materials to further strengthen Element 1.
- Optional enhancements (not required for CLASSICAL ranking) could include:
- A more explicit articulation of liturgical or devotional practices (within a non-sectarian framework) to reinforce liturgical/community rhythms in Element 1.
- Additional public-facing articulation of how Great Books/Great Conversations are woven into the daily schedule for grades K–8 to strengthen Element 3 further.
- More explicit portraits of the “living curriculum” and teacher-as-mentor language in Element 5 to deepen the sense that faculty are the core of the school’s classical identity.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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